

job became another full-time job and something people were actually expecting a conclusion from. I was MAXIMUM stressed out. My boyfriend at the time helped. My buddies helped. Facebook friends found me interviewees. Other interviewees linked me to more interviewees. Some of the people were nice. Some were very not nice. It was a crapshoot of strangers.

At the buzzer before my self-imposed deadline, I finished the project. I was also still working my full-time job. This project had netted me zero dollars, but it had gained me a little following and some respect on the Internet. (Such currency!) After it was done, I was approached by a small-time literary agent. I was thrilled. I thought my time had finally come. (I was 23. Relax, Gaby.) I was going to have a book! This had been my lifelong ambition ever since I'd won a blue ribbon at the Broward County Fair for my short story "My Very Bad Day!" (I have not changed at all.)

I wrote a proposal for a book based on the *100 Interviews* project. We shopped it around. Everyone passed. The agent stopped emailing me. I'd ruined my shot. (Relax, Gaby.) I went back to focusing on my day job, but AOL was suffering and my coworkers kept getting fired all around me. I was worried I'd be next.

Just to see if I could do it, I wrote a script for an original sitcom pilot based on my college friends. It was NOT GOOD. I mean, it was fine for a first attempt. I went to my Tumblr, where I knew from Google Analytics that I had 25,000 people who'd been reading the *100 Interviews* project. I wrote a post asking if anyone worked in Hollywood. If they did and they were a fan of my writing, would they be interested in reading a script I'd written? It was a bold move. Someone I no longer talk to mocked me for it at the time, calling the post "so desperate and tacky" to my face.

But it worked. An agent from the talent agency Gersh, based in LA, emailed me asking to read my script. He later became my first Hollywood agent. Another man, who worked in some capacity for Nickelodeon, also wanted to read it. (Four years later, that same guy gave me a job writing on a children's sketch show, my first TV writing gig.) Again, the script wasn't good, but it was a start. The point was to show people I was already doing the thing.